

Class Exercise 1: Operational Definition Practice

Instructions:

Create operational definitions for psychological constructs by filling out the chart below.

To do this, please read the provided independent variable (IV), participant variable (PV), or dependent variable (DV) construct within each experimental design, designated by a row in the chart. **Write in** a possible DV that could be an outcome of the IV/PV, or an IV/PV that could be a predictor of the DV. Then, explain how you would measure (operationalize) each IV/PV and DV in the design. **Generate** operational definitions with enough detail that another researcher could use this method in their own study. **Predict** the pattern of the relationship between the variables by drafting a hypothesis for how the IV might influence the DV (don't forget to include directionality!)

There are several ways to operationally define a variable/construct; please keep in mind that your definition should be executable (able to be carried out in real life) and **specific (e.g., if including a self-report survey, be sure to describe a few example questions on the survey).**

Upon filling out your chart in its entirety, please submit CE 1 to Canvas (**remember to save your last name in the document file name!**).

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Class Example					
Research Question	IV/PV	Dependent Variable	Operational Definition (i.e., how can we define these variables in a way that we can measure them?)	Count how many times flirting occurs based on your definition: (wait for the video)	Scale of Measurement for DV (nominal, ordinal, interval, ratio)
Is extraversion positively associated with flirtatious behavior?	Extraversion (participant variable): Operationalized as a personality trait measured using a self-report scale. Participants will rate how much they agree with the following statements (1 = Strongly disagree, 7 = Strongly agree): “I see myself as someone who is outgoing, sociable.”; “Tends to be quiet.”; Talks a lot.”	Behavioral Flirting	A specific action aimed at engaging in romantic closeness with another person.	6	Ratio

IV or PV (participant variable)	Manipulated (IV) or measured (PV)? Operational Definition for IV/PV	Potential DV	Operational Definition for DV	Scale of Measurement for DV (nominal, ordinal, interval, ratio)
Exercise	An intentional physical action that sustains a raised heart rate	Wellbeing	Self reported scale of how well one feels during a day	interval
belongingness training (i.e., to foster a sense of belonging among new college students)	Self-report on the feeling of belonging	academic involvement	How many academic classes or activities one is involved in	ratio
Level of education	1. High-school diploma 2. Bachelor's degree 3. Master's degree 4. PhD	Forgiveness	Whether or not one is able to forgive	nominal
Empathy	Taking a test that evaluates ones level of empathy	Road rage	How many times one reacts negatively to another person's driving	ratio
Country of birth	The country someone was born	Aggression	# of negative reactions	ratio
Temperature outside	Cold, cool, warm, hot, scolding	Interactions with others	How many people does one interact with	ratio

Predict the pattern of the relationship between the variables by drafting a hypothesis for how each IV/PV might influence its DV (don't forget to include directionality!)

IV/PV and DV	Hypothesis for the pattern of results
Extraversion and flirting	Extraversion will be positively associated with flirtatiousness, such that participants who report higher levels of extraversion will engage in more flirting behaviors.
Mindfulness training and rumination	Participants in the mindfulness condition will report less rumination than participants in the control condition.
Exercise and wellbeing	Exercise will result in a greater sense of wellbeing.
Belongingness and academic involvement	A greater sense of belongingness will have a positive association with a person's academic involvement
Empathy and road rage	Empathy and road rage will have a negative association.
Temperature outside and interactions with others.	The more extreme that the temperature outside is, the less interactions one will have with others.
Level of education and forgiveness.	People with a higher level of education are more likely to forgive.